

5.6 Issues and debates	Examples of issues and debates in clinical psychology: • Ethics (e.g. issues of diagnosing mental disorders such as using labelling; obtaining consent for participation in research; HCPC guidelines for practitioners). • Practical issues in the design and implementation of research (e.g. quantitative v qualitative data, balancing validity with reliability). • Reductionism (e.g. in research where causes of mental disorders are isolated and diagnoses are not holistic). • Comparisons between ways of explaining behaviour using different themes (e.g. ICD and DSM; different explanations for mental health issues). • Psychology as a science (e.g. in research that involves biological methods; in treatments such as drug therapies; in research that uses scientific research methods such as laboratory experiments). • Culture (e.g. cultural differences in diagnosis practices) and gender (e.g. gender featuring as a difference in frequency of a disorder). • Nature-nurture (e.g. different theories of what causes mental disorders, biological compared to social psychology). • An understanding of how psychological understanding has developed over time (e.g. DSM changes; changes in therapies; changing explanations for mental health issues). • Issues of social control (e.g. policies for the treatment and therapy for mental health issues can itself be seen as a form of social control). • The use of psychological knowledge within society (e.g. therapies and treatments for mental health issues). • Issues related to socially sensitive research (e.g. research in the area of mental health and cultural issues).
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